Architecture Content Framework

Module 6

Objectives

The objectives are to

- Explain the purpose of the Architecture Content Framework
- Describe the main components of the Content Metamodel
- Describe the relationship between the Architecture Content Framework and the TOGAF ADM

Introduction

- The Framework is a significant part of TOGAF
- It provides a detailed model of **architectural work products**
- It helps to improve the consistency of **TOGAF outputs**
  - Presents outputs in a consistent and structured way
  - Helps to reference and classify them

Benefits of the Architecture Content Framework

- It provides a comprehensive checklist of **architecture outputs**
- It promotes better **integration of work products** if adopted across an enterprise
- It provides a detailed open standard for **how architectures should be described**

Overview

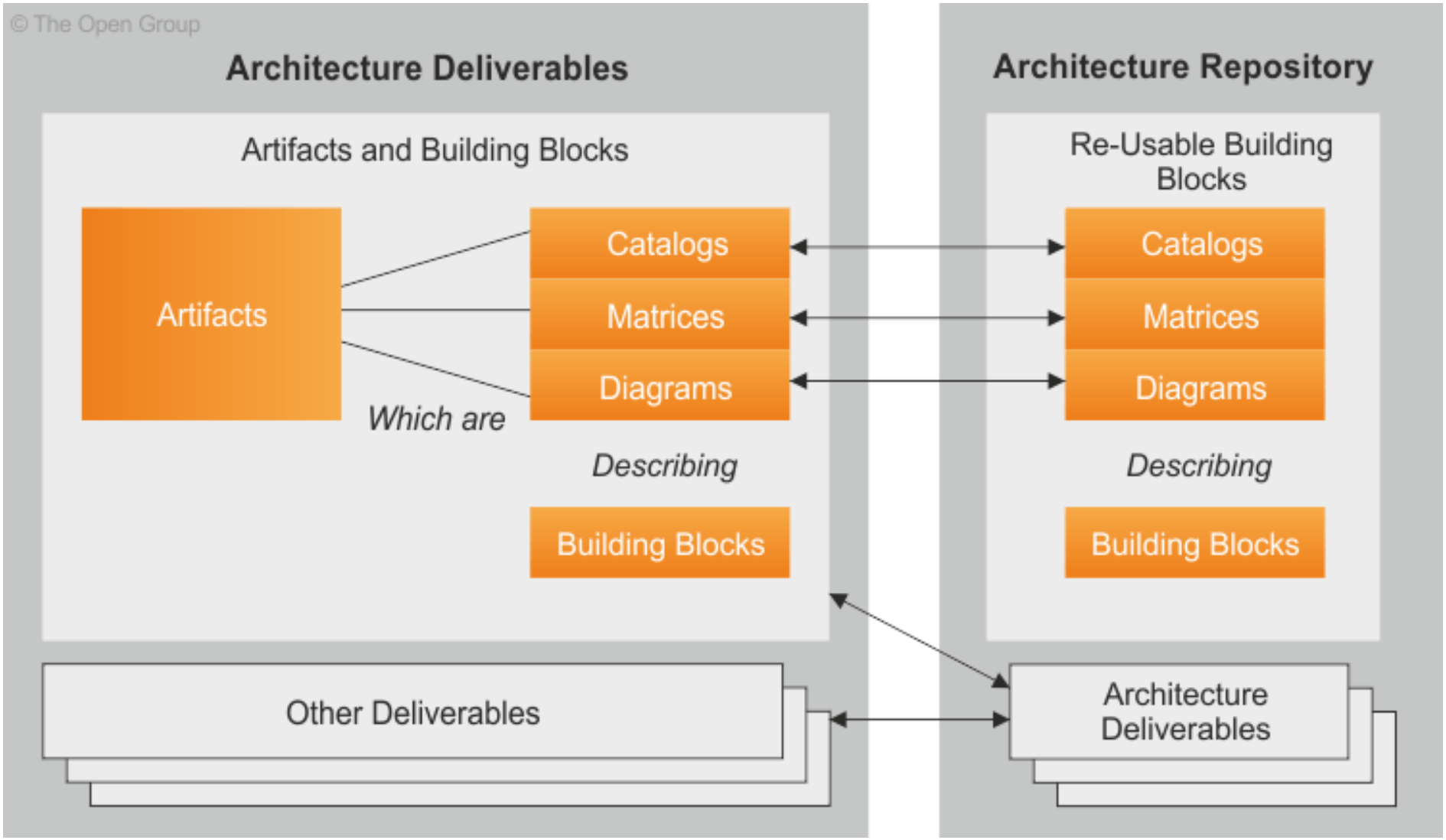
- The Framework has 3 categories for describing work products:
  - Deliverables
  - Artifacts
  - Building Blocks

Deliverables, Artifacts and Building Blocks

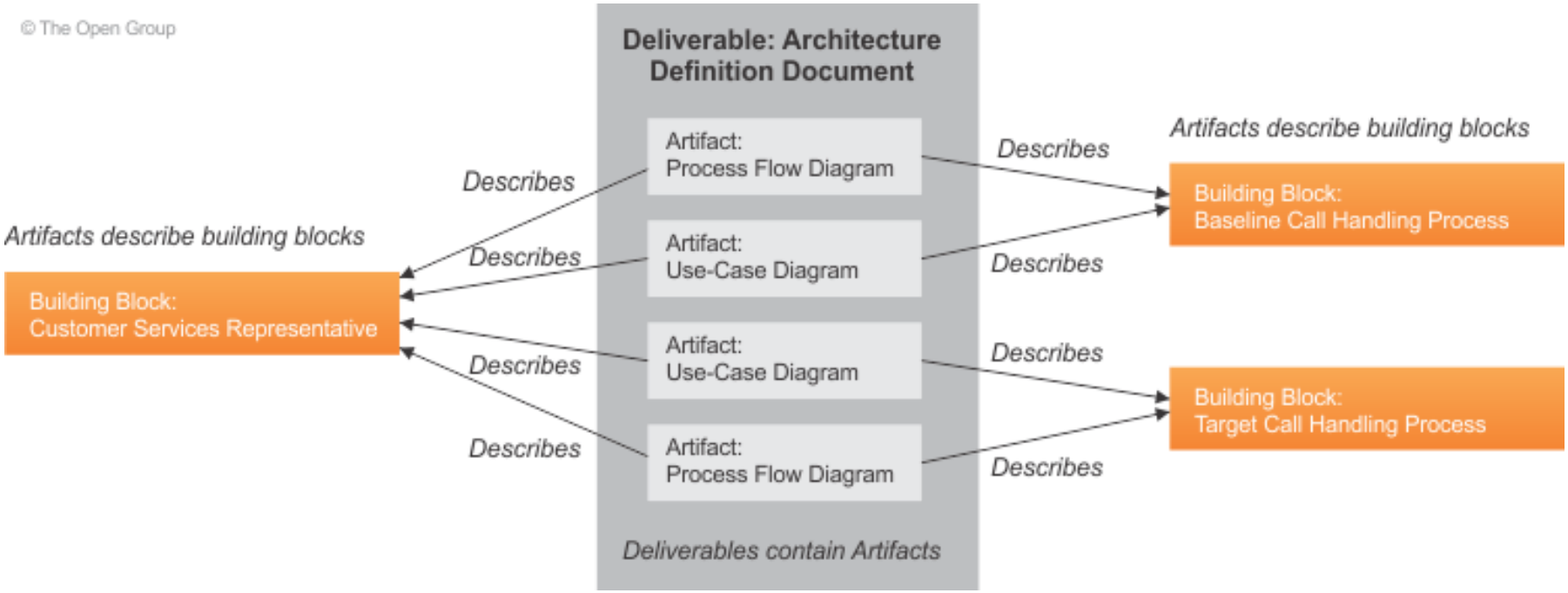
- **Deliverables**
  - **Formal products**
  - Contractually specified
  - Outputs from a projects
  - A deliverable can contain many artifacts
- **Building Blocks**
  - Components that can be combined with other building blocks **to deliver architectures and solutions**

- **Artifacts**
  - Fine grained products that describe an architecture from a specific viewpoint (use case specifications, network diagrams)
  - **Classified as:**
    - Catalogs
    - Matrices
    - Diagrams
  - Artifacts make up the content of the Architecture Repository

Relationship between Deliverables, Artifacts and Building Blocks



Example – Architecture Definition Document



Architectural Artifacts

- Artifacts are **products** that are created when developing an architecture
- An artifact is distinct from a deliverable, which is a contracted output from a project
- Usually **deliverables contain many artifacts** and each artifact may exist in many deliverables

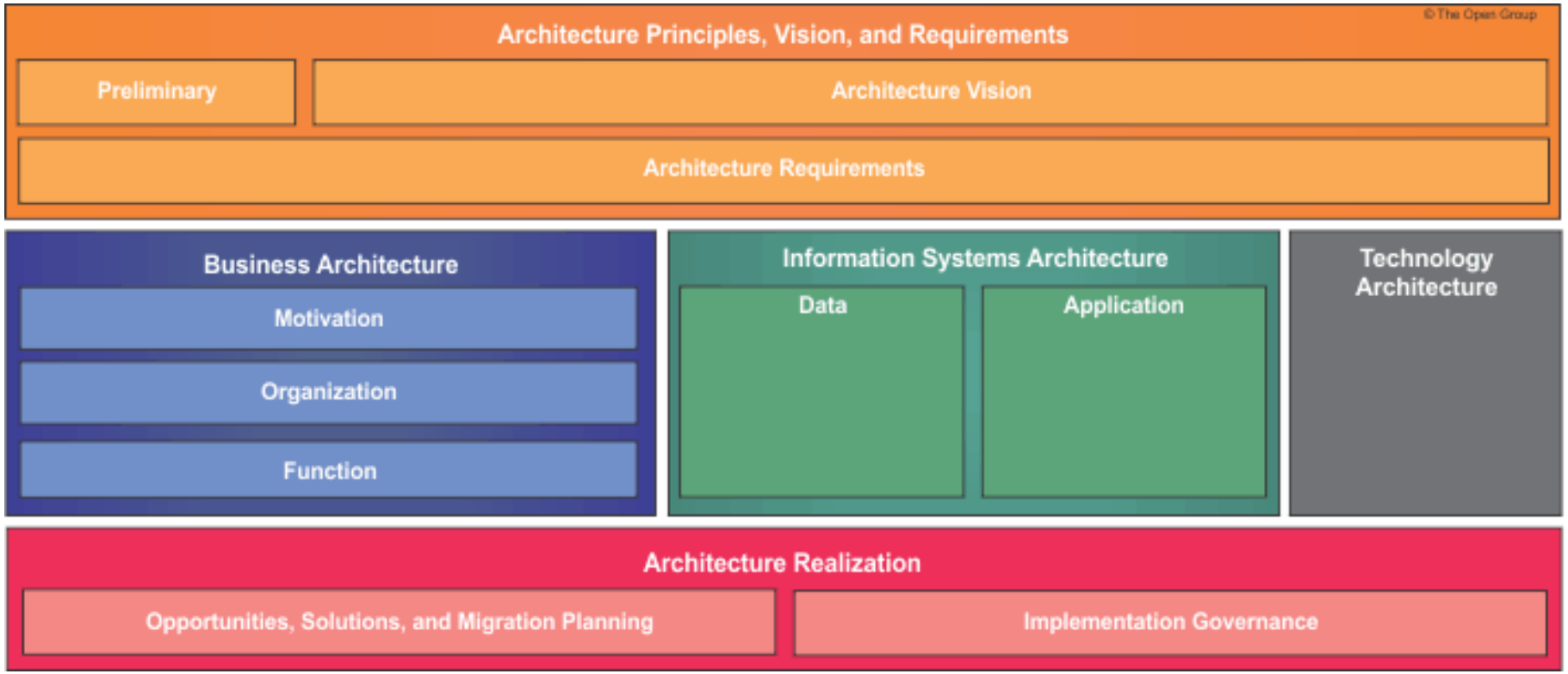
Content Metamodel

The framework is based on a standard content metamodel that defines all the types of **building blocks** in an architecture

- Showing how these building blocks can be described
- How they relate to one another

- The content model consists of a **core and extensions**
- **Catalogs**, **matrices** and **diagrams** are used to present the architectural information

Content Metamodel Overview

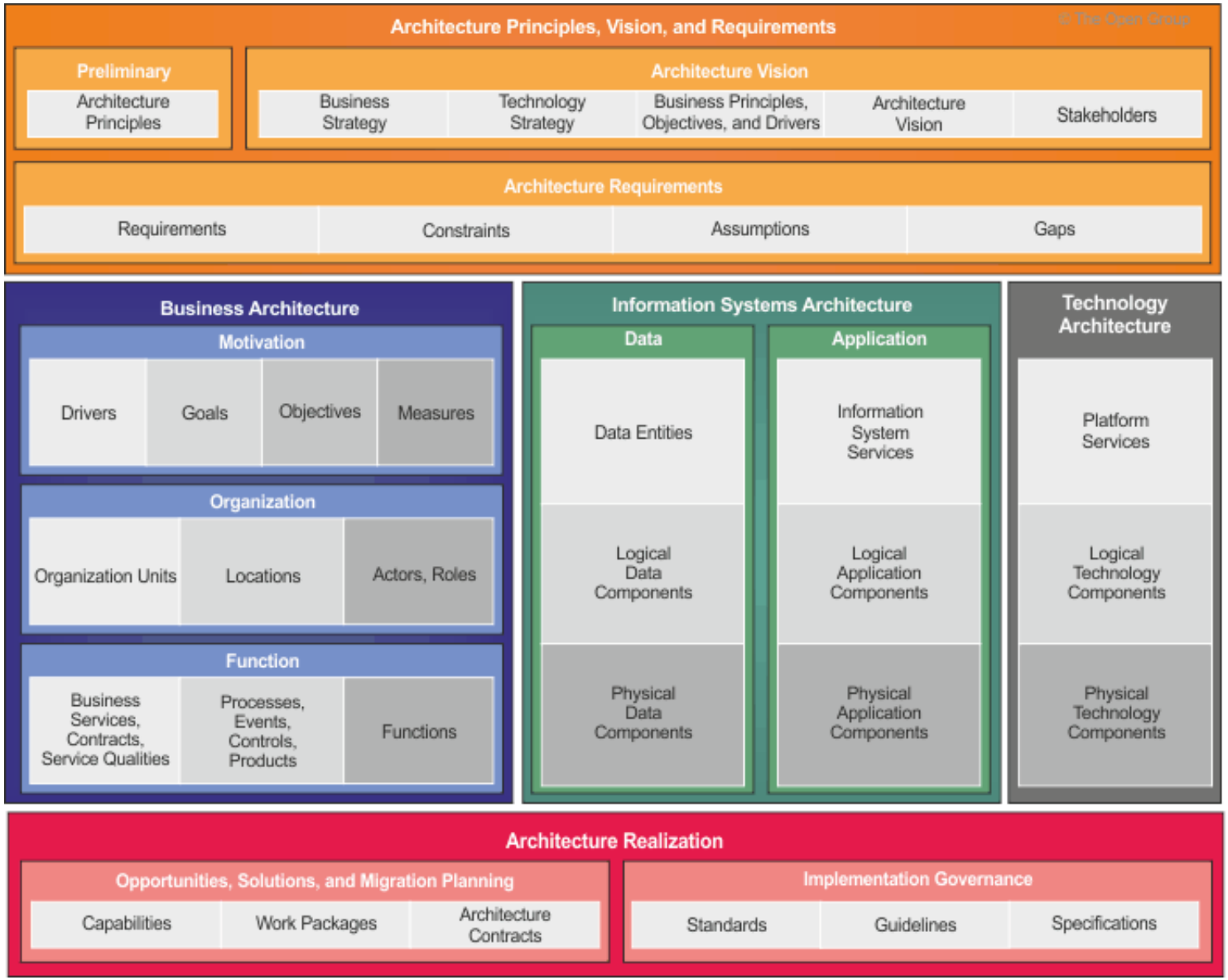


Mapping the Framework and the ADM

There is a mapping to the TOGAF ADM phases

- **Architecture Principles, Vision and Requirements** artifacts should capture the context of the architecture models, principles, strategic context and requirements
- **Business Architecture** artifacts capture architectural models of business operations, motivation factors, organization structure and functional capabilities
- **IS Architecture** artifacts capture architecture models of IT systems, specifically applications and data
- **Technology Architecture** artifacts capture procured technology assets used to implement and realize IS solutions
- **Architecture Realization** artifacts capture the transitions between architecture states and are used to steer and govern the implementation

Mapping the Framework and the ADM



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Content Framework and the TOGAF ADM

- The ADM addresses a business need through a process of vision, definition, planning and governance. At each stage the ADM takes information as **inputs** and creates **outputs**.
- The content framework provides a structure for the ADM that **defines inputs and outputs** in detail and puts each deliverable into the context of the architecture.
- So the content framework is **a companion** to the ADM.
- The **ADM** describes **what needs to be done** to create an architecture and the **content framework** describes **what it should look like** in the end.

Summary

- The Architecture Content Framework present outputs in a consistent and structured way
  - It has 3 categories of work products: **deliverables**, **artifacts** and **building blocks**
- The content metamodel consists of a **core** and some **extensions**
- **Catalogs**, **matrices** and **diagrams** are used to present the architectural information
- There is a **mapping** from the Architecture Content Framework to the TOGAF ADM phases